

December

26



Ancient takeaway

Almost 2,000 years after the city of Pompeii in Italy was buried during a volcanic eruption, archaeologists revealed they had uncovered a painted counter of an ancient street food shop, which sold fast food and drinks to hungry customers passing by.

2020

Also on this day

1898 In France, scientists **Marie and Pierre Curie** declared they had discovered a new element – radium.

1991 The Soviet of the Republics (part of the Soviet Union's law-making body) voted to end the Soviet Union.

2004 An earthquake in Sumatra, Indonesia, caused a huge tsunami that devastated areas near to the coast.

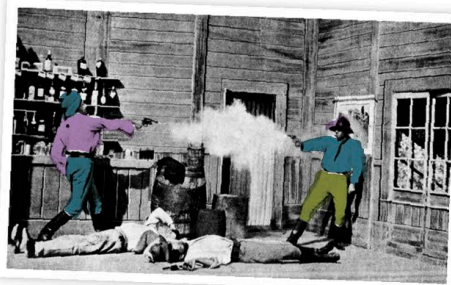


1966 Kwanzaa celebration

The first *Kwanzaa*, meaning “first fruit” in Swahili, began in Los Angeles, USA. The seven-day annual festival is celebrated by Americans of African descent.

Born this day

1791 **Charles Babbage**, British engineer. A pioneer of early computing, he designed the first mechanical computer, known as the Difference Engine, though he died before seeing his invention finished.



Feature film 1906

At 60 minutes long, *The Story of the Kelly Gang*, about the exploits of 19th-century outlaw Ned Kelly, became the world's first narrative feature film. Today only parts of the film survive.